

Pavan Kumar Nayakanti

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Engineering leader with 22+ years building and scaling high-performing technology teams for mission-critical enterprise platforms in regulated environments. Built and led teams of up to 35 engineers across ADP, Charles Schwab, BMO, and RBC -- delivering platform engineering, DevOps transformation, and cloud-native architectures at global scale. Deep expertise in Agile delivery (SAFe/Scrum), capacity planning, sprint execution, and engineering talent development. Proven track record driving proof-of-concepts for emerging technologies -- GenAI assistants, AIOps, and intelligent automation -- while governing SOX/GDPR-compliant software delivery across 250+ enterprise applications. Certified in KSRE, ITIL, Azure Solutions Architecture, and AI solution design; holds a Master's in Artificial Intelligence and ISB General Management Program. Brings the platform leadership, technical direction, and team-building capability to accelerate Lilly's Software Product Engineering mission.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Engineering Team Leadership & Mentoring

Enterprise Platform & Product Engineering

Agile Delivery (SAFe / Scrum)

Cloud Platforms (AWS / Azure)

Microservices & Container Orchestration (K8s)

DevOps & CI/CD Automation

ITSM / ITIL Service Management

Emerging Technology Adoption (GenAI / AIOps)

WORK EXPERIENCE

IRIS Software

Sep 2020 - Present

Sr. Specialist - Cloud Practice & SRE Lead | Clients: ADP, Charles Schwab, BMO

- Built and led the ADP SRE organisation from **4 to 35 engineers** across India, Canada, and the US -- established team topology, sprint cadence, capacity planning, performance management, and career development programmes.
- Founded and scaled Charles Schwab's **18-member Platform Engineering team** from zero -- defined technical standards, reliability reviews, delivery governance, and Agile sprint frameworks from the ground up.
- Drove adoption of engineering best practices across client platforms: blameless postmortem culture, structured incident management, and automated remediation workflows using Ansible and Python -- reducing MTTR by **40%+**.
- Designed and delivered **modeas**, a self-service deployment platform handling **200+ builds per hour**, eliminating 10,000+ manual operational hours annually and improving deployment cadence by 600%.
- Architected the Cloud Platform Maturity Index (CPMI) -- a scoring framework that benchmarked automation capability, cloud readiness, and engineering standards across ADP, Schwab, and BMO, directly influencing technology roadmaps at VP level.
- Drove proof-of-concepts for emerging technologies: deployed **GenAI assistants on Azure and AWS** for BMO risk summarisation and Q&A, reducing manual analysis effort; evaluated AI-assisted developer tooling for engineering team adoption.
- Led end-to-end on-premise to AWS cloud migration for BMO -- CDK-enabled CI/CD pipelines for .NET applications on ECS Fargate, with High Availability and Disaster Recovery built into the architecture.
- Conducted quarterly enterprise-wide training sessions (up to **200 participants per session**), scaling SRE, DevOps, and platform engineering capability across multiple organisations.

IRIS Software

Jun 2018 - Sep 2020

Automation Technology Specialist | Client: Royal Bank of Canada (Insurance)

- Governed enterprise DevOps and change management across **250+ applications and 60+ teams** -- standardised deployment workflows, enforced SOX/GDPR compliance, and delivered audit-ready change evidence pipelines.
- Designed and delivered the **Robo Deployment Framework** -- a PowerShell-native CI/CD orchestration platform that automated upgrade runbooks for Windows services, database deployments (SSIS, Oracle, SQL Server), and enterprise workloads, reducing application onboarding from **5 weeks to 5 hours (98% reduction)**.
- Led enterprise migration of 250+ applications across 60+ teams from CA SCM/Harvest to GitHub -- enabling modern CI/CD, Agile collaboration, and self-service provisioning at scale.
- Implemented Splunk-based log aggregation and alerting integrated with CI/CD workflows, enabling proactive incident detection and rapid response across production environments.

IRIS Software

Feb 2017 - Jun 2018

Automation Architect | Clients: Insurance & Capital Markets

- Designed fault-tolerant, container-orchestrated deployment pipelines using **Kubernetes and Helm** for zero-downtime rollouts across capital markets platforms.
- Led RPA practice delivery -- automated **80+ applications and 250+ components** across Java, Node.js, Kafka, Salesforce, and Mainframe stacks.
- Pioneered Cognitive and Intelligent Process Automation (CPA/IPA) through the Robotics Market Street programme, extending automation capability beyond rules-based RPA to agent-driven workflows.

TechMahindra

Jul 2015 - Feb 2017

Technology Manager | Client: Adobe

- Led cross-functional global engineering teams on large-scale enterprise delivery programmes -- aligning infrastructure and application technology initiatives with stakeholder expectations and business timelines.
- Architected and executed zero-downtime business application migration during Adobe's data centre relocation -- owned full plan, execution, and cutover across all production workloads.
- Led SAP HANA upgrades and ETL re-engineering from Informatica to SQL Server 2012, covering schema redesign and data validation at enterprise scale.

Microsoft Corporation

Jul 2007 - Dec 2014

Sr. SDET - Platform Reliability & QA Automation

- Delivered platform reliability and QA automation engineering for Microsoft's global marketing platforms -- achieved sustained **99.99% uptime** over 7 years through proactive SLI monitoring and automated recovery.
- Built and led QA automation frameworks integrated with CI/CD pipelines -- embedded automated regression, service virtualisation, and performance testing into release gates.
- Partnered with cross-functional product and infrastructure teams in Agile environments to define reliability targets, manage error budgets, and support 200% user growth with zero critical incidents.

Semantic Space Technologies

Jan 2005 - Jun 2007

Senior Software Testing Engineer | Client: Bank of America (CFC)

- Sole L3 Analyst supporting the Statusmart application for 3,000+ sales team members at CFC (later Bank of America) -- managed release management, QA, and incident triage via Remedy.

KEY PROGRAMMES & PLATFORMS

ADP SRE Organisation Scale-Up Team Leadership

Built and scaled ADP's SRE org from 4 to 35 engineers across India, Canada, and the US. Established team topology, sprint cadence, performance management, blameless postmortem culture, and automated remediation workflows. Reduced MTTR by 40%+ across ADP's multi-service enterprise platform.

Prometheus, Grafana, Dynatrace, Ansible, Python, Keptn (Chaos Engineering)

Robo Deployment Framework - RBC Insurance Deployment Automation

Designed and delivered a PowerShell-native CI/CD orchestration platform that automated upgrade runbooks and release pipelines for 250+ enterprise applications across 60+ teams. Reduced application onboarding from 5 weeks to 5 hours (98% reduction) with full SOX/GDPR audit evidence automation.

PowerShell, Python, Ansible, Splunk, GitHub, SSIS, Oracle, SQL Server

modeas - High-Throughput Deployment Platform Internal Platform Product

Architected and delivered modeas, a self-service enterprise deployment platform processing 200+ builds/deployments per hour. Eliminated 10,000+ manual operational hours annually, improved deployment cadence by 600%, and was adopted across multiple major banking clients as the standard deployment engine.

Kubernetes, Docker, Helm, Terraform, GitHub Actions, AWS CDK

BMO GenAI Assistants - Emerging Technology POC GenAI / Innovation

Drove proof-of-concept and production deployment of GenAI-based risk summarisation and Q&A assistants for BMO using Azure and AWS platforms (BCRG and LTS pipelines). Reduced manual document analysis effort and established a template for AI-assisted operations across the engineering team.

Azure OpenAI, AWS Bedrock, Python, REST APIs, BCRG pipeline

EDUCATION

Masters in Artificial Intelligence - Woolf University	2024
General Management Program (GMP) - ISB Hyderabad	2022
M.Sc in Computer Science - Osmania University	2002

CERTIFICATIONS

Microsoft Certified: Azure Solutions Architect Expert (AZ-305)	2026
AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate (SAA-C01)	2026
Certified Kubernetes Application Developer (CKAD)	2025
AI-102: Microsoft Azure AI Solution Design (Microsoft)	2025
PMI Agile Certified Professional (PMI-ACP)	
Certified SRE (iSRE) ITIL Certificate in IT Service Operations	
DP-100: Data Science Solution on Azure AZ-305: Azure Infrastructure Solutions	2025

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- Cloud & Platform:** AWS, Microsoft Azure, Kubernetes, Docker, Helm, Terraform, AWS CDK, Ansible
- CI/CD & DevOps:** GitHub Actions, Jenkins, GitLab, UrbanCode, ArgoCD-compatible GitOps pipelines
- Programming:** Python, Bash, PowerShell, Groovy, C#.Net, Go
- Observability & ITSM:** Prometheus, Grafana, Dynatrace, Splunk, AppDynamics, ServiceNow, ITIL
- Microservices & Architecture:** ECS Fargate, Kubernetes-native microservices, SOA, event-driven (Kafka)
- Emerging Tech:** GenAI (Azure OpenAI, AWS Bedrock), AIOps, MLOps, RPA (UiPath, Automation Anywhere)
- Agile & Delivery:** SAFe, Scrum, Jira, capacity planning, sprint estimation, risk management